

Kenya Institute of Primate Research

Data Science and Analytics Section (DSAS)

These are the key achievements of DSAS in brief since the section was activated on **28 September, 2025** through the deployment of an officer. Issue 9 is about research sovereignty, genomic data, and intellectual property.

Notable achievements and impact

1. Provided statistical support to five (5) institutional research projects through study design, statistical planning, data analysis, and interpretation, enhancing the quality of research outputs.
2. Developed, Co-developed and submitted four (4) research proposals to funding agencies for funding consideration, supporting institutional resource mobilization.
3. Trained, mentored and supervised Ten (10) interns and industrial attachment students in statistics, data science, and research methods, strengthening institutional capacity.
4. Established strong collaborative working relationships with all research and professional divisions, promoting multidisciplinary research and informed decision-making.
5. Led KIPRE's registration with the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (ODPC), strengthening institutional compliance with the Data Protection Act, 2019.
6. Developed one institutional dashboard to support ASWED in hematological studies and other institutional experiments using NHPs.

Working collaborations established

1. Collaborated with all KIPRE research and professional divisions by providing statistical, data management, and analytical support throughout the research lifecycle.
2. Supported multidisciplinary research teams in proposal development, data analysis, and scientific reporting.

Strategies DSAS employed

1. Early integration of statistical support in research projects.
2. Strong multidisciplinary collaboration across departments.
3. Continuous mentorship and capacity building.
4. Adoption of digital tools for data management, visualization, and reporting.

Key challenges

The Section is currently staffed by only one technical officer despite providing institute-wide statistical and data science support, limiting its capacity to meet the growing demand.

Inadequate office space for consultations, collaborative work, and mentorship of interns and attachment students.